REFEREE AID - CLOSE COMBAT

Close Combat for the purpose of this aid is defined as unarmed and melee combat between two or more participants. In order to initiate Close Combat, you must be in the same hex as you target. There can be no barriers between you. Cover has no effect against Close Combat attacks.

Ambushing

Ambushing a target in close combat requires sneaking up into the same hex as the target. In order to ambush a target in close combat, you must make an opposed Recon skill roll. The roll becomes progressively harder the closer you approach to your target. If you fail, the target spots you at the starting point of your move. Successful ambushes in Close Combat result in the attacker drawing the first initiative card. Their first attack gains a +3 modifier.

AMBUSHING

RANGE	RECON MODIFIER
Same hex	–2
1 hex	–1
2–5 hexes	0
6–20 hexes	+1
21+ hexes	+2

Combat initiated

Players may **swap turns** if able to communicate. pg. 55.

Draw initiative cards. Lowest card goes first.

Surprise/Ambushes go first. Surprises reference pg. 54. Ambushes reference pg. 60.

Participant banks 2 fast actions, or 1 fast and one slow action.

Movement or fast action(s) taken

Free actions

See list of all actions, pg. 56. **Helping others** uses an action akin to their slowest action pg. 55.

Determine type of Close Combat Attack

Turn interruption: Declaration of intent to block

Determine all To-Hit Modifiers. The attack is a slow action.

Close Combat attack: Roll Strength and Close Combat dice

Hit?

Target Missed (End of participant's turn)

Push?

Target Missed (End of participant's turn)

Reroll any STR and CC dice, that aren't ✸s, or ⌖s.

Player may reroll ⌖ at their own discretion.

MISHAP: A single ✸: -1 Reliability from weapon, or 1 dmg if fighting unarmed.

Weapon base DMG. Add +1 for each extra ⌖.

Note: Any Close Combat attacks made **while prone** will hit the legs of a standing opponent.

Roll hit location 1d6

Hit Location

1	Legs
2-4	Torso
5	Arm
6	Head

Target wearing armor?

Apply weapon's armor modifier if there is one.

Reduce damage by armor value.

Apply armor ablation to armor. Roll 1D6. -1 Rel for each ✸ rolled. pg. 73.

Greater than critical threshold?

Roll on the critical tables pg. 76

If remaining dmg = the weapon's critical threshold +2, roll twice on the crit table. pg. 74.

Apply damage and any criticals.

Information on recovering from damage and criticals can be found starting on pg. 73.

Blocking:

When attacked in Close Combat, you *may* spend a fast action attempting to block the strike. You must declare your intent to block before the attacker makes their roll, breaking the turn order. Blocking is not an opposed roll, so you may push it, declaring that you wish to do so after an attacker pushes their own roll. For every block you perform, you get one less fast action on your own turn in the round, meaning that once you block twice, you lose any further actions that round and cannot block again. All actions are refreshed at the beginning of the round - you may save your actions to block attacks, but your saved actions will never carry from one round to the next.

Effects: While blocking, every ⌖ that you roll will negate one ⌖ from the opponent's roll.

Foot Movement:

In a single fast action, you can move 2 combat hexes (20m). To move further, you need to make a Mobility roll modified by the terrain type of the hex you're in. For every ⌖ you roll, you can move an additional hex. If you fail the roll, you move no further.

Stance: In order to run, you must be standing. Going from prone to standing is a fast action. Dropping to prone is a free action.

Backpack: Carrying a backpack gives a -2 modifier to all Mobility rolls. Dropping your backpack is a free action.

Crawling: Crawling characters are prone, and move 1 hex (10m) instead of 2. Additional mobility successes result in 1 additional hex being moved, but no more.

Elevation: Movement cost to gain elevation is 2 hexes instead of 1. You must succeed on a mobility roll to crawl up a hill.

Swamps and Shallows: Movement counts as crawling in this terrain. Actual crawling is impossible.

TERRAIN TYPES

TERRAIN	PAVEMENT	FIELD	SHRUB-LAND	DEBRIS	FOREST	FOLIAGE	SWAMP	SHALLOWS	BLOCKING	INDOORS
	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢	⬢
VISIBILITY	∞	∞	∞	∞	3	1	∞	∞	None	∞
RANGED ATTACKS	–	–	–1	–1	–1	–2	–	–	n/a	–1
MOVEMENT	–	–	–1	–2	–1	–3	Special	Special	n/a	–2
COVER	No	No	No	Yes (3)	Yes (2)	No	No	No	n/a	Yes (1)
INFILTRATION	–2	–1	–	+1	+1	+2	+1	–	n/a	+1

Actions during Close Combat:

Diving Blow: Slow action. If, in the same round, you run into the same hex as the target and make an unarmed blow, this is called a Diving Blow, and it gives a +2 modifier to the Close Combat attack roll. If it hits successfully, both you and the target fall to the ground prone. If the attack fails, only the attacker falls prone. Diving Blows may be blocked.

Shoving: As a fast action, you can attempt to shove or push an opponent to the ground. A single success on a Close Combat roll is needed, unless the target has higher Strength than you, in which case two successes are necessary. The shove itself causes no damage, and can be blocked.

Disarming: As a fast action, you can attempt to disarm your opponent with a Close Combat roll. If the opponent is holding something in one hand, only a single success is needed. If the item is being held in both hands, two successes are needed. Additional successes have no effect, and the attack itself causes no damage. The attempt may be blocked.

Grappling: As a slow action, you can attempt to grapple your opponent with a Close Combat roll. No weapon can be used, and the grapple can be blocked. If the attack succeeds, both the attacker and the target fall to the ground. The target drops any weapons they were holding, and cannot move. At that point, the target may only attempt to break free, which is a slow action and an opposed roll against the attacker. While grappling, the attacker may attempt to attack the target grappled with a normal unarmed attack (fast action however) which cannot be blocked.

Retreat: If you have an active enemy in your hex (with no barrier between you) and you try to retreat, you must roll mobility. If you fail, you still move, but the enemy gets an immediate free-action Close Combat attack on you. The free attack occurs out of turn order, cannot be blocked, and does not count against the enemy's actions.

Examples pg. 62:

Attacker Prone	**-2**
Target Prone	**+2**
Defenseless Target	**+3**
Aimed Blow	**-2**
Diving Blow	**+2**

Note: Attack modifiers against a prone target do not stack with those against a defenseless target.

Thrown weapons require a Mobility roll to hit and do not require preparation before an attack..

TYPICAL BARRIERS

BARRIER	HEIGHT	ARMOR LEVEL
Concrete wall	High	3
Brick wall	Low	2
House wall	High	2
Indoor wall	High	1
Sandbags	Low	4 or more
Barbed wire	Low	–

Barriers

Barriers represent obstacles on the tactical map, and can include things such as indoor and outdoor walls, sandbag emplacements, and barbed wire. They can be high, blocking visibility entirely, or low, blocking visibility only to prone characters. Barriers can provide cover from attacks, including Close Combat attacks.

Divided Hexes: Barriers can often divide a hex. You must determine what side of barrier your character is on, and Close Combat attacks may not be made over barriers (even low ones).

Crossing Barriers: Low barriers can be jumped with a successful Mobility roll (fast action), while high barriers require a successful Mobility roll (slow action). Some high barriers cannot be crossed (such as an indoor wall). Failure means you do not cross the barrier.

Barbed Wire: Doesn't reduce visibility, but crossing requires a Mobility roll. Failure results in 1 dmg. Concertina gives a -2 modifier to the roll, and failure results in critical #3 to your legs pg 76.

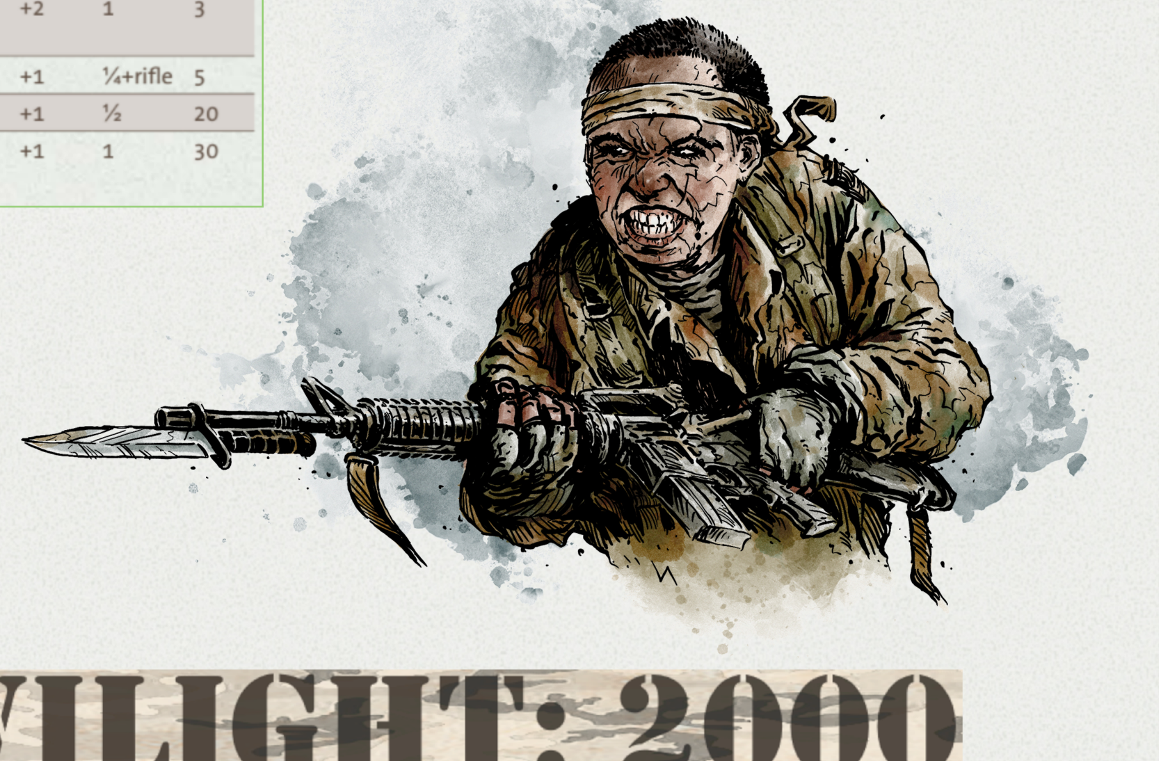
Doorways: Moving through a doorway counts as a fast action, but requires no roll. Locked doors have 5 HP, and can be picked with a successful Tech roll. pg. 59.

Melee Weapon Examples:

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	REL	DAMAGE	CRIT	ARMOR	WEIGHT	PRICE
Unarmed	5	1	4	+3	–	–
Rifle butt	5	2	4	+2	As rifle	–
Bottle	1	1	2	+3	¼	–
Knife	5	2	3	+1	¼	5
Club*	5	2	4	+2	1	1
Spiked bat*	5	2	3	+2	1	3
Bayonet	5	2	3	+1	¼+rifle	5
Machete	5	3	4	+1	½	20
Axe	5	3	3	+1	1	30

*Can be jury rigged.



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